

PAST BEDTIME - Game Proposal

TGC Game Jam x GDAI x Infinium '26. Themes: Comic, Twist, Light. Engine: Unity 6 (URP). Platform: Web (itch.io, HTML5).

Team

Name	Email	IndieConnect ID	Role
Soham Pawar	sohampawar246@gmail.com	@sohampawar246	Solo developer (design, code, art, audio)

Team size: 1 (solo). Team member: Soham Pawar, email sohampawar246@gmail.com, IndieConnect ID @sohampawar246.

Logline

It's 2 AM. Roshan is reading a comic in bed by the light of a wind-up torch, and the comic only happens where it is being read.

The pitch

You play both sides of the page at once. The mouse is Roshan's torch; the keyboard is Max Voltage, the comic's hero. Everything inside the beam is alive. Everything outside it is frozen mid-panel: goons mid-punch, bullets mid-air, a piano stuck over someone's head. You fight, platform and choreograph the comic by choosing what to read.

The comic lies on the bed, and Mom's bedroom door is always in view in the corner of the screen. When the hallway light comes on, footsteps approach and the handle turns, you click the torch off and the whole comic freezes, until she leaves.

How the three themes are used

Theme	In the game
Comic	The world is a comic page: panels, gutters, Ben-Day dots, SFX lettering (KAPOW, KRAK, WHIRR), speech bubbles you can stand on. It is also a comedy: a kid hiding from Mom, enemies frozen in embarrassing poses.
Light	The torch decides what is alive. Lens colours add side effects. Mom's hallway light is a rival light that wakes whatever it touches, and in the finale she switches on the room light and wakes everything at once.
Twist	Twist the crank to charge the torch, but the spring only holds so much: overwind it and the bulb flares, waking the whole page and alerting Mom. Twist the lens wheel to change colour. The ending is a twist too: Mom ends up reading the comic herself.

Core mechanics

- 1. Only what's lit is alive.** Every moving thing is Awake or Frozen. Frozen things keep their momentum and stay solid, so you can stand on them. Damage only happens between two awake things, and Inkies can hurt each other: freeze a goon mid-punch, line another goon up in front of it, re-light, and the punch lands on its friend.
 - 2. Twist to charge.** The beam's size is the torch's charge (60 seconds of light). Scroll the mouse wheel to twist the crank: +2 s per notch. At full the crank clicks a warning; past it, a 3-notch overwind buffer fills; one more and the bulb flares (1.5 s page-wide wake, 2 s of darkness, Mom hears it).
 - 3. Lenses (one effect, one catch each).** Clear: baseline light. Green (Mend): heals Max in the beam, but heals enemies too. Red (Hush): Mom can barely see it, but the beam is smaller. Ghost (violet): reveals invisible-ink platforms and secret stars, but drains twice as fast.
 - 4. Mom.** A visible door with clear stages: hallway light, footsteps, handle turns, door creaks open (her light wedge falls onto the page and wakes things). Torch on while she's looking fills suspicion; at 100 you're BUSTED and lose one of three slippers. Lose all three: GROUNDED.
 - 5. Upgrades.** Stars hidden on each page are spent at the Nightstand between acts on Spring (more capacity), Gear (more charge per twist) and Ratchet (bigger overwind buffer).
- Hero:** Max Voltage has a 3-hit punch chain, kick, launcher, dodge, ground slam and a Splash Page super that hits every enemy inside the beam. No double jump: height comes from freezing things to stand on.

Structure (about 14 minutes)

Act	Pages	Introduces
1. Night of the Blot (rooftops)	1-3	The core rule, fighting, freeze-steps, twisting and overwind, first Mom visit, Green lens
2. The Inkworks (factory)	4-6	Moving machinery, the Bruiser, Mom opening the door, Red lens, Baron Blot phase 1 (he escapes into invisible ink)
3. Blot's Tower	7-9	Ghost lens and invisible ink, a rising ink flood, final fight with every lens; Mom flips the room light for a 30-second all-awake finale

Art and audio

Two worlds, deliberately opposite. Inside the comic: black-and-white 1950s print (ink outlines, Ben-Day halftone, hatching), with colour only on SFX lettering and the torch lens tint. Around it: Roshan's colourful, slightly realistic bedroom at 2 AM, with Mom's door always in view. Audio obeys the light: frozen things are silent, and switching the torch off tape-stops the music. Mom is told through sound: slippers, the door handle, the creak.

Assets: all free and listed in CREDITS.md: Quaternius characters and animations (CC0), Kenney sound packs (CC0), Poly Haven textures (CC0), CC0 and CC BY music, SIL OFL fonts, plus our own Blender models and recordings. AI tools (Claude Code, Unity MCP, KlingAI for the studio logo) are disclosed in AI_DISCLOSURE.md.

Scope we commit to

Must-have: the core freeze rule on the page in the bedroom; twist-to-charge with overwind and flare; Max's combat; three enemy types (Smudge, Dot-Shot, Bruiser); Mom with the visible door, suspicion and Busted; Clear, Green and Red lenses with the Spring upgrade; 9 pages in 3 acts ending with Baron Blot and the room-light finale; the comic shader, lettering and HUD; main menu, settings, credits, epilepsy warning and studio intro.

Stretch: Ghost lens and invisible ink, Gear and Ratchet upgrades, a fourth enemy (Eraser), gamepad support.

Plan: Hours 12-36 core slice (freeze rule, one fight, charging, shader); 36-60 Acts 1-2 and Mom; 60-84 Act 3 and boss; 84-100 polish, audio and a stable web build. Playable web builds uploaded at Hours 60 and 84; commits every 1-2 hours. Final submission: 6 Oct 2026, 4 PM IST.

Contact

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